

If the number is a currency value, you have a range of prefixes to choose from. The default is '\$'; you can change this to 'INR'. Unfortunately, there is no 'Rs.'. Under 'Date', you have a wide range of options—as mentioned earlier, dates are treated as numbers in Excel, so you can choose how the number appears, as a date. It's a similar case with the 'Time' option. If you choose 'Text', the number will be treated as text, and it appears exactly as it is entered. There's another option here, 'Custom', which will be discussed later.

Alignment: This is, of course, for specifying the alignment of the cell—the horizontal and vertical alignment, the angle at which the text should appear, and so on and so forth.

Font: In addition to specifying the font and font style, you can also specify the font size, colour, whether it's underlined, whether it's to be superscripted, and so on.

Border: This specifies the border you'll give the cell—the gridlines that show up on the sheet are not the cell's borders; they will not show up when you print the page. But when you specify a border, it will show up when you print.

Patterns: Here you specify how the cell should be shaded, and with what colour. There are several textures available, and, of course, you can choose any colour at all.

Protection: Here you can choose to 'lock' a cell, meaning that no-one else can change its contents, and also to hide a cell. But, as mentioned in the dialog box, this has no effect unless the workbook is protected. To protect the workbook with a password, go to **Tools > Protection**.

3.4.3.2 Custom Formatting

Under the 'Number' tab in the Format Cells dialog box, you have an option called 'Custom', as we mentioned earlier. Custom formats cover a wide range. Here's a sampler: For more information on custom formats, do a search in Excel Help for 'number format codes'.